

Property Investment Purchase Checklist — Tasmania

Due diligence for buying an investment property, beyond what a homebuyer checklist covers.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only — not financial, tax or legal advice. Engage a qualified accountant, mortgage broker, and conveyancer before purchasing.

Section 1 — Structuring the Purchase

- ☐ ☐ **Decide on ownership structure before you buy** — individual, joint, trust, or company each carry different land tax and asset-protection implications.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand Tasmania's land tax threshold.** This increased from \$99,999 to **\$124,999** from the land tax year commencing 1 July 2024 — check whether it has moved further since, as Tasmania has periodically adjusted this threshold.
- ☐ ☐ **Budget for the foreign purchaser surcharge if relevant.** Foreign purchasers of residential property in Tasmania pay an additional **8.0% surcharge** on top of standard transfer duty, calculated on the full contract price — separate from any federal FIRB application fee.
- ☐ ☐ **Understand investor stamp duty is unaffected by the first-home-buyer transition.** The major FHB duty exemption/grant changes described in Checklist #1 apply specifically to first home buyers — as an investor, you're subject to standard transfer duty rates regardless of these first-home-buyer-specific settings.
- ☐ ☐ **Get investment-specific finance pre-approval.**

Section 2 — Due Diligence on the Property Itself

- ☐ ☐ **Order a building and pest inspection before you sign** — remember, Tasmania has no cooling-off period, so this needs to happen (or be a robust contract condition) before, not after, signing.
- ☐ ☐ **Have a conveyancer or solicitor review the contract before you sign.**
- ☐ ☐ **If buying a strata property, review the strata records thoroughly** — sinking fund health and special levies directly affect your investment returns.
- ☐ ☐ **Research the local rental market specifically** — vacancy rates, comparable rents, and tenant demand for your target Hobart, Launceston, or regional Tasmanian area.

Section 3 — Setting Up for Compliance From Day One

- ☐ ☐ **Budget for minimum standards compliance** under Part 3B of the Residential Tenancy Act 1997, and smoke alarm compliance under Part 3A — factor any necessary work into your purchase budget.
- ☐ ☐ **Decide on self-management vs. a property manager** — Tasmania's dispute process (Residential Tenancy Commissioner, then Magistrates Court, plus the newer TASCAT pet-dispute pathway) differs structurally from most other states, so genuine familiarity matters if self-managing.
- ☐ ☐ **Arrange landlord insurance**, separate from standard building insurance.
- ☐ ☐ **Engage a quantity surveyor for a tax depreciation schedule** shortly after settlement — see the separate Tax & Depreciation Checklist in this series.
- ☐ ☐ **Prepare for pet-related tenancy requests** — since consent is required by default in Tasmania (rather than an automatic approval right), have a clear, reasonable policy in mind rather than a blanket refusal, which risks being found unreasonable if disputed at TASCAT.

Section 4 — Understanding the Current Tax Environment

- ☐ ☐ **Be aware Commonwealth CGT settings for investment property are changing**, with reforms affecting the CGT discount generally applying from **1 July 2027** — confirm the finalised current position with your accountant.
- ☐ ☐ **Get advice on purchase and sale timing relative to this changeover** if your investment horizon spans the 2027 transition.

Quick Reference — TAS Investment Property Snapshot (July 2026)

ITEM	DETAIL
Land tax threshold	\$124,999 (increased from \$99,999, from 1 July 2024)
Foreign purchaser surcharge duty	8.0%
Cooling-off period	None
Pet requests	Consent required by default; blanket refusal not permitted
Dispute resolution	Residential Tenancy Commissioner / Magistrates Court (TASCAT for pet disputes only)

Land tax and surcharge rates change with state budgets — always confirm current figures with the State Revenue Office Tasmania before settling on a purchase strategy.

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